

# RUSSIA

Key Country Details Table

| Detail                    | Information                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Full Name</b>          | Russian Federation                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Short Form</b>         | Russia                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Capital</b>            | Moscow                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Region (UN)</b>        | Eastern Europe                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Government Type</b>    | Federal semi-presidential constitutional republic                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Head of State</b>      | President Vladimir Putin                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Head of Government</b> | Prime Minister Mikhail Mishustin                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Currency</b>           | Russian Ruble (RUB)                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>UN Member Since</b>    | 24 October 1945 (as USSR); continued membership as Russian Federation in 1991                                                                                                |
| <b>MUN Standing</b>       | Permanent member of the UN Security Council; active in global diplomacy, though recent actions have led to suspensions from certain UN bodies due to international concerns. |

## Recommended Books on Russia's Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. **"Russia's Foreign Policy: Change and Continuity in National Identity"** – Andrei P. Tsygankov
2. **"Russian Foreign Policy: The Return of Great Power Politics"** – Jeffrey Mankoff
3. **"Russia and the United Nations: A Difficult Relationship"** – Richard Sakwa
4. **"The Limits of Partnership: U.S.-Russian Relations in the Twenty-First Century"** – Angela E. Stent
5. **"Russia in the United Nations: A Critical Assessment"** – Edited by Alexei G. Arbatov

## Research Table: Russia & the UNHRC

| Source Name                     | Link                                      | Why It's Useful                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Human Rights Watch (HRW)</b> | <a href="#">World Report 2025: Russia</a> | Details violations of press freedom, protest rights, and judiciary independence. Offers NGO-based evidence useful for building a critical case. Excellent for human rights status updates. |

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|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>UN News</b>                        | <a href="#"><u>UNGA Suspends Russia from UNHRC</u></a>      | Official UN press coverage of Russia's suspension. Includes voting records and reasons. Indispensable for diplomatic background.                                                          |
| <b>United Nations Digital Library</b> | <a href="#"><u>UNGA Resolution ES-11/3 (Suspension)</u></a> | The primary source of the official resolution that suspended Russia. Full text and voting info included. Must-have for any formal position paper.                                         |
| <b>UN OHCHR</b>                       | <a href="#"><u>Commission of Inquiry on Ukraine</u></a>     | Highlights Russian actions in Ukraine under UN investigation. Important for connecting external aggression to human rights issues. Supports ICC/Nuremberg-style accountability arguments. |

| Source Name                                      | Link                                                                                                                                                                                 | Why It's Useful                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| OHCHR – Russia Country Page                      | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/russian-federation"><u>https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/russian-federation</u></a>                                                     | UN assessments of human rights in Russia           |
| Russian Ombudsman for Human Rights               | <a href="http://ombudsmanrf.org"><u>http://ombudsmanrf.org</u></a>                                                                                                                   | Official human rights reports                      |
| Amnesty International – Russia Reports           | <a href="https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/russian-federation/"><u>https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/russian-federation/</u></a> | Independent human rights reports                   |
| Human Rights Watch – Russia                      | <a href="https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/russia"><u>https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/russia</u></a>                                                                   | Analysis of human rights issues                    |
| Council of Europe – Russia Judgments             | <a href="https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/"><u>https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/</u></a>                                                                                                         | European Court of Human Rights cases               |
| <a href="#"><u>UNHRC Statements – Russia</u></a> | <a href="https://ap.ohchr.org/documents/alldocs.aspx"><u>https://ap.ohchr.org/documents/alldocs.aspx</u></a>                                                                         | Texts of Russia's statements at HRC                |
| UN Web TV – Russia at HRC                        | <a href="https://webtv.un.org"><u>https://webtv.un.org</u></a>                                                                                                                       | Videos of Russia's participation                   |
| Freedom House – Russia Report                    | <a href="https://freedomhouse.org/country/russia/freedom-world/2023"><u>https://freedomhouse.org/country/russia/freedom-world/2023</u></a>                                           | Assessment of political rights and civil liberties |
| ISHR – Russia and HRC Membership                 | <a href="https://ishr.ch/latest-updates/do-not-elect-russia-to-un-human-rights-council/"><u>https://ishr.ch/latest-updates/do-not-elect-russia-to-un-human-rights-council/</u></a>   | Analysis of Russia's role in HRC                   |

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|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| UN Treaty Body Reports – Russia | <a href="https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/TBSearch.aspx">https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/TBSearch.aspx</a> | Compliance with human rights treaties |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|

## Unique Aspects of Russia in the UNHRC Context

1.

**First Permanent Member Suspended from UNHRC:** Russia has made history by becoming the first permanent member of the UN Security Council (P5) to be suspended from the UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC). This significant move underscores the serious global concerns regarding its human rights record and establishes a powerful diplomatic precedent.

2.

**Continued Influence Despite Suspension:** Even though it's been suspended, Russia is still making its presence felt through backdoor diplomacy, pushing anti-Western resolutions, and keeping its observer status. This shows just how strong its soft power remains and its knack for influencing groups like BRICS and CSTO.

3.

**Weaponization of Human Rights Narratives:** Russia often turns the tables on human rights criticisms by pointing out the hypocrisy and double standards of the West. It cleverly employs the language of sovereignty and traditional values to push back against Western liberal narratives at the UN.

4.

**Instrumental Use of Human Rights Law Domestically:** Russia is known for its selective approach to human rights, often cracking down on dissent, media, and NGOs while claiming it's all in the name of national security. This inconsistent application really puts the UNHRC's universality doctrine to the test.

5.

**Target of Multiple UN Investigations:** Russia is currently facing a number of UN-mandated investigations concerning alleged war crimes in Ukraine and issues of internal repression. This situation has positioned it as one of the most closely examined countries in the history of the UN Human Rights Council.

6.

**Geopolitical Shielding via Veto and Allies:** Despite facing widespread condemnation, Russia finds a safety net in its diplomatic ties with allies like China and Iran. This support not only protects it from collective action but also makes it harder for the UN Human Rights Council to enforce its mechanisms.

7.

**Narrative of "Cultural Sovereignty" vs. Western Liberalism:** Russia promotes a narrative centered around defending "traditional values" while pushing back against what it terms "Western cultural imperialism." This approach resonates with conservative nations and has significantly influenced discussions on human rights at the UN.

8.

**High Diplomatic Cost of Exclusion:** The recent UNGA vote to suspend Russia stirred up quite a bit of controversy, with several major non-aligned countries choosing to abstain or oppose the motion. This really highlights the tough decisions that Russia's situation forces upon the Global South.

9.

**Backlash-Driven Human Rights Clampdown:** After its suspension, Russia ramped up its domestic crackdowns on dissent, showcasing a troubling trend of retaliatory repression. The link between UN scrutiny and internal repression has become particularly intense.

10.

**Framing the UNHRC as Politicized:** Russia often claims that the UNHRC is just a tool of the West, rather than a truly neutral body for human rights. This stance not only questions the Council's legitimacy on a global scale but also supports a narrative of multipolarity in international governance.

Diplomacy